Listening Section

In the listening section, you will answer up to 47 questions to demonstrate how well you understand spoken English. There are three types of tasks.

Type of Task	Description
Listen and Choose a Response	Select the best response to the question or statement.
Conversations	Answer questions about short conversations.
Listen to announcements and academic talks.	Answer questions about announcements and academic talks.

You WILL NOT be able to return to previous questions.

Listening Section, Module 1

In an actual test, the clock will show you how much time you have to complete each question.

You can use Next move to the next question.

You WILL NOT be able to return to previous questions.

Choose the best response.

1. **Man: How can I get this light to work?**
   (A) The lighter one is over there.
   (B) There's a switch on the back wall.
   (C) The side door is open.
   (D) I prefer to work at home.

2. **Woman: I'm not available tomorrow.**
   (A) Let's try to get there early.
   (B) What's a better day for you?
   (C) It's not on my schedule either.
   (D) I was in a meeting last night.

3. **Man: The campus talent contest will be held next Saturday evening.**
   (A) I can hold that for you.
   (B) Stage lighting is usually very hot.
   (C) My roommate is a talented basketball player.
   (D) Do you know who the judges will be?

4. **Man: What time do I need to pick up Michael from the train station?**
   (A) Don't worry about it--I'll get him.
   (B) He said he prefers the window seat.
   (C) The station now has a snack shop.
   (D) There's road construction near the entrance.

5. **Woman: Isn't the grocery store open late tonight?**
   (A) Yes, it is.
   (B) No, shopping takes time.
   (C) It's next to the store.
   (D) I'd rather not.

6. **Woman: Did you bring the identification documents?**
   (A) They are in the blue folder.
   (B) Who can identify them?
   (C) Both can be done.
   (D) Yes, I would.

7. **Man: Wait, isn't the concert tomorrow night?**
   (A) No, it's tonight.
   (B) No, I can't wait.
   (C) Yes, I would.
   (D) Yes, that's fine.

8. Woman: I'm not available this afternoon.

(A) So am I.
(B) It takes a while.
(C) I didn't mean it.
(D) Well, I understand.

Listen to a conversation.

Man: I think my laptop is acting up again. It keeps freezing and shutting down randomly.
Woman: That's frustrating. Have you tried restarting it or running a virus scan?
Man: Yes, I did both, but it didn't help. I might need to take it to a repair shop.
Woman: That sounds like a good idea. They should be able to diagnose and fix the issue.
Man: I'll do that this afternoon.

9. What problem is the man experiencing with his laptop?

(A) It has a cracked screen.
(B) It won't turn on.
(C) It keeps freezing and shutting down.
(D) It is running slowly.

10. What will the man most likely do next?

(A) Buy a new laptop
(B) Run another virus scan
(C) Take his laptop to a repair shop
(D) Restart his laptop

Listen to a conversation.

Man: Are you going to the supermarket today by any chance?
Woman: I was just there yesterday. Why?
Man: I suddenly remembered that I'm supposed to bring some drinks to my team's lunch meeting tomorrow at work, and I'm in the middle of a project I need to finish tonight.
Woman: You're in luck. I stocked up yesterday.

11. What is the man's problem?

(A) He has nothing to eat for lunch.
(B) He is unable to attend a meeting.
(C) He forgot about an obligation at work.
(D) He needs more resources to finish a project.

12. What does the woman imply when she says, "I stocked up yesterday"?

(A) She does not plan to go to work tomorrow.
(B) She will provide the man with drinks for his meeting.
(C) The supermarket has plenty of drinks available.
(D) The man will not need extra time to finish his project.

Listen to an announcement at a university club meeting.

Announcer: Welcome to the creative writing club's monthly meeting! Before we get started, I wanted to remind you of the guidelines for our upcoming short-story contest. We're looking for stories on the theme of family, and all stories must be submitted by the end of November to be considered. Good luck to everyone participating!

13. Why does the speaker mention family?

(A) It is the topic of the story they are reading.
(B) It was discussed at last month's meeting.
(C) It is a contest theme.
(D) Families are invited to the next meeting.

14. What does the speaker encourage the participants to do?

(A) Observe the guidelines
(B) Read last month's submissions
(C) Prepare for a presentation
(D) Join the club's mailing list

Listen to a talk in a physics class.

Professor: Dark matter is a type of matter that doesn't emit, absorb, or reflect light, making it invisible to current instruments. Despite being unobservable directly, it's believed to make up about 27 percent of the universe's mass-energy content. How do scientists know dark matter exists? Well, all the stars in a galaxy rotate around the center of their galaxy. According to basic physics, the farther a star is from the center of a galaxy, the slower it should rotate. However, observations show that stars in the outer regions of galaxies rotate at unexpectedly high speeds. This anomaly suggests that a massive, unseen matter is exerting gravitational force, keeping the stars moving faster than expected.

Dark matter is hugely important for the structure of the universe. Computer simulations show that galaxies wouldn't have formed the way they did if dark matter hadn't been around. But what does dark matter consist of? Well, there are different theories, so let's consider a couple of them.

15. What is the main topic of the talk?

(A) How gravity affects stars
(B) Material in the universe that cannot be directly seen
(C) The distribution of stars in galaxies
(D) The formation of the universe

16. According to the speaker, how do scientists infer the existence of dark matter?

(A) From the temperature of visible matter
(B) From the amount of light in the universe
(C) From the number of stars in galaxies
(D) From the speed of stars' movement

17. Why does the speaker mention computer simulations?

(A) To support the claim that dark matter plays an important role in the universe
(B) To describe how the gravitational forces acting on stars were calculated
(C) To highlight the anomalies in basic physics
(D) To explain how the speeds of stars were measured

18. What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

(A) Measurements of dark matter in galaxies
(B) Ideas about dark matter's composition
(C) The anomalies in galaxy rotation caused by dark matter
(D) The distribution of dark matter in the universe

Listening Section, Module 2

In an actual test, the clock will show you how much time you have to complete each question.

You can use Next move to the next question.
You WILL NOT be able to return to previous questions.

Choose the best response.

1. **Woman: Who is responsible for the project timeline?**
   (A) I do.
   (B) I'm not sure.
   (C) A few unexpected delays.
   (D) It stays on track.

2. **Woman: Why did the team meeting get canceled?**
   (A) Two days ago.
   (B) Meeting attendees.
   (C) Actually, it was rescheduled.
   (D) How about another time?

3. **Man: Can you assist me with my science report?**
   (A) Let me know what you think.
   (B) You're very kind.
   (C) What exactly do you need help with?
   (D) It doesn't matter.

4. **Man: I'm not sure about the current plan.**
   (A) That's unfortunate.
   (B) Sure, I can.
   (C) I think you have it.
   (D) No, it's planned.

5. **Man: If you need help, ask Ms. Johnson.**
   (A) Either is fine by me.
   (B) Happy to help.
   (C) That's what I'll do.
   (D) I'm available.

6. **Woman: What time does the event start?**
   (A) In the party room.
   (B) At 1 p.m.
   (C) It's crowded.
   (D) Event coordinators.

7. **Man: Who is hosting the party tonight?**
   (A) The marketing team is.
   (B) It's tonight.
   (C) I can't help it.
   (D) It's good for two days.

8. Man: Let's go hiking this weekend.

(A) Maybe it is.
(B) Why not this weekend instead?
(C) Have you checked the weather?
(D) Are you busy?

Listen to a conversation.

Man: Have you returned the books we borrowed from the library?
Woman: Why? I thought we could keep them for six weeks.
Man: Actually, it's now four weeks. They changed the policy. I guess I forgot to tell you!
Woman: That means they're due tomorrow!
Man: Exactly!
Woman: In that case, I'll take care of it right now!

9. What was the woman not aware of?

(A) The library's new location
(B) The library's borrowing policy
(C) The library's holiday schedule
(D) The library's hours of operation

10. What will the woman probably do next?

(A) Return books to the library
(B) Make a phone call to the library
(C) Pay a fine for returning books late
(D) Borrow a new book from the library

Listen to an announcement on the campus radio station.

Announcer: Good evening everyone. Just a friendly reminder that the university's annual charity auction will take place tomorrow at 7 P.M. in the Main Hall. All proceeds will go to local charities. We hope to see you there and appreciate your support!

11. What is the main topic of the announcement?

(A) A new university event
(B) A lecture on local charities
(C) A change in venue
(D) An upcoming fundraiser

12. What does the speaker hope the listeners will do?

(A) Attend an event
(B) Prepare for a lecture
(C) Donate online
(D) Volunteer at an event

Listen to a talk in an environmental science class.

Professor: Biomimicry is the human practice of learning from and imitating things found in nature in order to create new inventions. This way, scientists and engineers can create innovative solutions that are both efficient and sustainable.

One well-known example of biomimicry is the development of a widely used fastening system. The inventor was inspired by the way burrs, uh thorns, from plants stuck to his dog's fur. By replicating the tiny hooks found on the burrs he removed from the dog fur, he created the new fastening system. Another example is the design of energy-efficient buildings based on the ventilation system of structures created by termites. Termites are ground-dwelling insects that use different materials to create hills, or mounds, in which the termites live. Termite mounds have a complex network of vents. The vents maintain a stable internal temperature, which can be emulated in human architecture.

Biomimicry can also be applied to renewable energy. For instance, researchers are developing wind turbine blades modeled after the flippers of humpback whales. The unique shape of the flippers reduces drag and increases efficiency, leading to more effective wind energy capture.

13. What is the talk mainly about?

(A) Ways in which humans use natural materials in clothing and architecture
(B) Hiding strategies of different animals
(C) New methods of using renewable energy
(D) Examples of how humans imitate nature for practical purposes

14. Why does the speaker mention a dog?

(A) To illustrate how an inventor copied animal behavior
(B) To compare its efficiency in movement with that of humpback whales
(C) To explain how a structure found in plants inspired an invention
(D) To show the close bond between scientists and animals

15. What point does the speaker make about termite mounds?

(A) The temperature inside of them does not change much.
(B) Termites sometimes build them near human-made structures.
(C) Building them takes a lot of energy.
(D) They are created mostly from plant material.

16. What does the speaker imply about wind turbine blades that are being developed?

(A) The noise they create can be harmful to whales.
(B) They can be easily installed on buildings.
(C) They can be efficiently constructed from renewable materials.
(D) They are very similar to some whales' flippers in shape.